The Coca-Cola Company

# 3Q25 Earnings Prep

## Our 3Q OSG of +5.2% is ahead of Consensus (+4.8%) but we are in-line on EPS of $0.78 for the quarter.

| | |
|---|---|
| KO | OVERWEIGHT |
| U.S. CHPC & Beverages | NEUTRAL |
| Price Target | USD 71.00 |
| Price (17-Oct-25) | USD 68.44 |
| Potential Upside/Downside | +3.7% |

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

U.S. CHPC & Beverages
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Near-term expectations have come in over the last several weeks in light of a few market callouts that have emerged across Staples. We still expect to see a sequential volumetric acceleration in 3Q (albeit smaller than what we assumed coming out of last quarter's print), and we expect 4Q OSG to decelerate QoQ given the tougher comp. All in, we are anchored to the low end of KO's +5-6% OSG guide for the year that, importantly, still screens attractive across the peer group. Amidst a macro backdrop that remains uncertain and challenging, we still like KO as a high-quality business that has some of the best visibility into topline momentum within our coverage.

## Current Consensus Expectations

**---- 3Q25 ----**

- 3Q25 EPS: $0.78 [$0.76-$0.81 range, Barclays = $0.78]
- 3Q25 sales growth: +4.1% [+2.7% to +6.0% range, Barclays = +4.3%, +5.2% organic]

**---- 2025 ----**

- 2025 EPS: $2.98 [$2.95-$3.02 range, Barclays = $2.97]
- 2025 sales growth: +3.2% [+2.6% to +3.9% range, Barclays = +3.1%, +5.1% organic]

**---- 2026 ----**

- 2026 EPS: $3.19 [$2.59-$3.32 range, Barclays = $3.20]
- 2026 sales growth: +5.5% [Barclays = +5.6%, +5.4% organic]

*Source: Consensus figures from Bloomberg*

## Our Thoughts

We still expect a sequential volumetric acceleration QoQ, although KO's messaging at our conference coupled with broader Staples company callouts on certain markets over the last several weeks tempered near-term expectations (*Conference Takeaways*, 09/03/25). For our part, we are anchored to the low end of KO's +5-6% OSG guide for the year that, importantly, still screens attractive across the peer group. So while we can understand heightened focus from investors on the volume profile at KO for 3Q and looking into 2026, there hasn't been anything to suggest something is structurally changed within the KO brand portfolio. Amidst a macro backdrop that remains uncertain and challenging, we still like KO as a high-quality business that has some of the best visibility into topline momentum within our coverage.

For 3Q, we look for total company organic sales to grow +5.2%, with the tempered forecast shared in our preview (vs. +6.2% previously) largely driven by softer concentrate sales embedded in our model (+1.0% vs. +1.9% previously) whereas our price/mix was largely unchanged (+4.2% vs. prior +4.3% ). The softer volume outlook was led by a -100 bps reduction to APAC and LatAm – both of which had markets called out by KO during our conference (e.g. Mexico, India, Thailand, Vietnam) and that have emerged as bigger watch points across Staples more broadly in the last several weeks – and we also lowered our BIG concentrate assumption by -150 bps for the quarter. Of note, we suspect the GST increase on soft drinks in India announced in early September could have prompted some pre-buying towards the end of the quarter ahead of the change taking place on 9/22/25, but we don't think this is enough to offset broader macro/weather pressures for the market in 3Q. Layering in a -0.9% drag from currency pressure, we look for net sales to grow +4.3% this quarter. We forecast ~50 bps of gross margin expansion in the quarter, with SG&A as a percent of sales at 30% that translates to an operating margin of 31.6% (+85 bps YoY). We look for 3Q EPS of $0.78 that is in-line with Consensus.

## What Matters Most To Us

- Perspective on recent  volumes trends and consumer health across key markets
- Latest on full-year outlook
- Progress on US focus areas, particularly Fairlife & brand Coke

## Guidance Recap

**---- 3Q25 ----**

- Currency: 1% headwind to revenues; 5-6% headwind to EPS (based on rates as of April and inclusive of hedged positions)

**---- 2025 ----**

- Organic revenue growth: +5-6%
- EPS growth: +3% (currency neutral +8%)
- Currency: 1-2% headwind to revenues and 5% headwind to earnings (both including the impact of hedged positions)
- Structural: ~1% headwind to comparable net revenues and EPS
- Tax rate: ~20.8%, not including any impact of ongoing tax litigation
- FCF: $9.5 billion, excluding Fairlife contingent consideration
- OCF: $11.7 billion, excluding Fairlife contingent consideration
- Capex: $2.2 billion

**---- Long-Term Guidance ----**

- Organic revenue growth +4-6%
- Comparable, FX-neutral operating income growth 6% to 8%
- Comparable, FX-neutral EPS growth +7-9%
- Adjusted free cash flow conversion 90% to 95%
- CapEx at 4.5% to 5% of net revenue
- Target of 2 to 2.5x net debt leverage

## KO 3Q25 Earnings Call Details

Tuesday, October 21st @ 8:30 a.m. ET - US: 888-415-4465; International: 646-960-0140; Passcode: 6819315

As always, please feel free to call with any questions or comments.

Best,

Lauren

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**The Coca-Cola Company** (KO, 17-Oct-2025, USD 68.44), Overweight/Neutral, CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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**U.S. CHPC & Beverages**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
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| Coca-Cola Europacific Partners plc (CCE.AS) | Coca-Cola Europacific Partners plc (CCEP) | Colgate-Palmolive (CL) |
| Constellation Brands (STZ) | Coty Inc. (COTY) | Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC) |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR) | International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF) | Kenvue Inc. (KVUE) |
| Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP) | Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB) | Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP) |
| Newell Brands Inc. (NWL) | ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD) | Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX) |
| PepsiCo Inc. (PEP) | Primo Brands Corporation (PRMB) | Procter & Gamble (PG) |
| Reynolds Consumer Products (REYN) | The Coca-Cola Company (KO) | The Estée Lauder Companies (EL) |

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## The Coca-Cola Company (KO / KO)

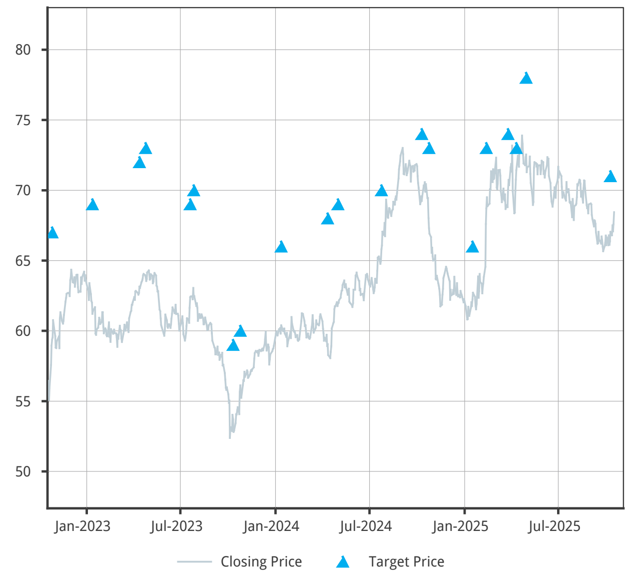
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 68.44** (17-Oct-2025)

**Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 17-Oct-2025)**

Currency=USD




Source: IDC, Barclays Research

Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting

| Publication Date | Closing Price* | Rating | Adjusted Price Target |
|---|---|---|---|
| 10-Oct-2025 | 66.12 | | 71.00 |
| 30-Apr-2025 | 72.35 | | 78.00 |
| 11-Apr-2025 | 70.76 | | 73.00 |
| 26-Mar-2025 | 68.95 | | 74.00 |
| 12-Feb-2025 | 67.60 | | 73.00 |
| 16-Jan-2025 | 61.77 | | 66.00 |
| 24-Oct-2024 | 68.01 | | 73.00 |
| 10-Oct-2024 | 69.57 | | 74.00 |
| 24-Jul-2024 | 64.96 | | 70.00 |
| 01-May-2024 | 61.77 | | 69.00 |
| 11-Apr-2024 | 59.72 | | 68.00 |
| 12-Jan-2024 | 59.81 | | 66.00 |
| 25-Oct-2023 | 55.64 | | 60.00 |
| 11-Oct-2023 | 54.03 | | 59.00 |
| 27-Jul-2023 | 63.05 | | 70.00 |
| 20-Jul-2023 | 61.64 | | 69.00 |
| 25-Apr-2023 | 63.95 | | 73.00 |
| 13-Apr-2023 | 62.69 | | 72.00 |
| 12-Jan-2023 | 61.21 | | 69.00 |
| 26-Oct-2022 | 58.95 | | 67.00 |

On 20-Oct-2022, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 62.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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**Valuation Methodology:** Our price target of $71 is based on a ~22.2x P/E reflecting a +HSD% premium to the more defensive, multinational peers on our CY26 EPS estimate of $3.20.

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